

Sales Training — Session 44

Progress Is Supposed to Feel Slow.

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WHAT THIS SESSION IS The single biggest reason people quit meaningful pursuits too early: progress almost never feels like progress while you're living it. Success is repetitive. It's uncomfortable. It's slow. This session is about recognising that pattern, refusing to treat it as evidence you're on the wrong path, and staying in the game long enough for compounding to do the work compounding is designed to do.

1. The reason most people quit too early

Not because they're incapable. Not because they've hit some genuine wall. Not because the path is wrong for them. They quit because progress, while it's happening, almost never LOOKS like progress. There's no cinematic music. There's no visible curve going up. There's just today, which feels roughly the same as yesterday, which felt roughly the same as the day before that. When the felt experience doesn't match the imagined experience, the rep starts to doubt whether anything is actually working — and doubt is what produces the exit.

The corrective is understanding, up front, that progress is SUPPOSED to feel slow. That isn't a bug in the rep's experience — it's the nature of building anything worthwhile. If a rep expects progress to feel exciting, they'll interpret the boring middle as failure. If they expect it to feel slow, they'll interpret the boring middle as exactly what it is: the boring middle, on the way to the outcome.

"Success is rarely exciting in the moment. It's repetitive. It's uncomfortable. It's slow. If you understand that, you'll stay in the game long enough to achieve things most people never will."

2. What worthwhile achievements actually look like from inside

Think about any goal worth having. Building a career. Learning a new skill. Starting a business. Growing a client base. Improving as a salesperson. None of these happen overnight. All of them involve long periods where the rep is doing the work, wondering if it's landing, unable to see the change from inside their own life.

The change is happening. It's just invisible on the daily timescale. Only when the rep steps back at the six-month or twelve-month mark does the amount of ground actually covered become visible. That's why journals, records, and vision boards matter — they compress the invisible daily gains into a form the rep can actually see. Without a mechanism to visualise cumulative progress, the rep's daily perception is the only perception they have. And daily perception says nothing changed today.

"When you're in the middle of the journey, it often feels like nothing is changing. You question whether you're moving. Look back months later — that's when you realise how much ground you've actually covered."

3. Time plays tricks — slow in the middle, fast in retrospect

A specific cognitive distortion worth naming. When a rep is working through a difficult stretch, time feels incredibly slow. One challenging day can feel like a week. One tough month can feel like forever. The stretch feels like it will never end.

Then the stretch does end. Weeks pass. Months pass. Years pass. The same time period that felt like it stretched forever now feels like it happened in the blink of an eye. "That whole horrible summer — was it really only three months?" Yes. It was. Time slows in difficulty and accelerates in retrospect. Both perceptions are real, and neither is the whole truth.

The operational implication: never judge progress based on how it feels in the moment. Moment-perception is unreliable. Judge progress on consistency of action, not on emotional readings. If the rep has done the work every day for 30 days, they've made progress — even if today feels like nothing changed. Consistency is the measurement. Emotion is the noise.

"Progress isn't measured by emotion. It's measured by consistency. The felt experience is unreliable. The behaviour isn't."

4. Corie's history — the seasons that built everything

Corie shared several stretches from his own career that were, at the time, genuinely difficult. Starting businesses. Facing financial pressure that felt terminal. Nearly losing everything more than once. Borrowing money from his parents just to keep moving. None of those moments felt like success while he was living them. Many felt like straight-out failure. Some felt like proof he'd chosen the wrong path entirely.

Looking back now, those seasons were the foundation for everything that followed. The skills he needed later were built during those hard stretches. The resilience he uses today is muscle he built on those months where every day felt like it might be the last one. The relationships that support the current business were formed in the rooms where things were going wrong. Sometimes the experiences you wish had never happened become the exact experiences that prepare you for what's next.

"Sometimes the experiences you wish had never happened become the very experiences that prepare you for your future."

5. The myth of the easier path

A quiet belief many reps carry: that other people — the ones who are further ahead, more successful, further along — had it easier. That the path they walked was smoother, the setbacks were fewer, and the outcomes were somehow more available to them. It's a comforting belief. It's also almost always wrong.

Successful people don't typically have an easier path. They have the same path — with the same amount of hardship, setbacks, and moments where quitting was tempting. The difference isn't in the terrain. It's in the response to the terrain. They refused to let setbacks become stopping points. They treated each obstacle as another lesson. They kept walking during the months where walking felt pointless.

"The difference isn't that successful people avoid setbacks. The difference is they refuse to let setbacks become stopping points."

6. Corie's pilot's licence — chosen discomfort

A specific worked example from Corie's own recent experience. He didn't need to become a pilot for his career. It wasn't required for the business. He didn't have deep prior interest in flying. He chose to pursue the licence for one reason: he wanted to prove something to himself. He wanted to put himself back into a situation where he was uncomfortable, learning was difficult, failure was possible, and quitting was tempting.

Why choose that voluntarily? Because it's easy to encourage other people to leave their comfort zone. It's much harder to do it yourself. The pilot's licence was Corie's own commitment to the same principle he preaches to the team — periodically choose something that will genuinely stretch you, precisely so you don't atrophy. Coaches who don't play get soft. So do leaders who don't push themselves. The licence was a way to keep the muscle sharp.

7. Learning to fly — what persistence actually looks like

The pilot's licence itself was harder than the seven-year-old version of the idea suggested. There were delays. Unexpected problems. Study material that didn't stick the first time. Early mornings. Long days. Moments of pure frustration. Plenty of legitimate opportunities to quit — the kind that would have been socially acceptable and even reasonable to accept.

Every one of those obstacles reinforced the same lesson: meaningful goals demand persistence. If achieving something significant was easy, everyone would do it. The DIFFICULTY isn't a bug in meaningful goals — it's part of what gives the achievement its value at the end. The rep who wants a meaningful career doesn't get to opt out of the difficult stretches. They only get to choose whether they persist through them or not.

"If achieving something important was easy, everyone would do it. The difficulty is part of what gives the achievement its value."

8. Applied to sales — the normal rhythm

Some days a rep hears "no" over and over. Some weeks the pipeline feels stubbornly slow. Some months the rep wonders whether the effort is producing any return at all. That isn't a signal something is wrong. That's the normal rhythm of the work — the felt experience of

building something over time. The mistake is treating temporary frustration as evidence of permanent failure. It isn't. It's just Tuesday.

The response is unglamorous. Keep making the calls. Keep improving the conversations. Keep learning from every appointment. Keep doing what's consistent even when today's outcome doesn't match today's effort. Momentum is built one action at a time — not because any single action produces the momentum, but because the accumulation of them does. Ten calls on a bad Tuesday doesn't feel like momentum. Ten calls on a bad Tuesday, every Tuesday, for six months IS momentum. The rep just can't see it until the six months have passed.

9. Real confidence is proof, not praise

A quieter observation buried inside the persistence principle. Every time a rep overcomes something difficult — a hard week, a lost deal that hurt, a stretch of doubt they pushed through — their confidence grows. Not because someone told them they were capable. Because they proved it to themselves. That kind of confidence sits deeper than the version built on praise. It's structurally different. Praise-based confidence collapses when the praise stops. Proof-based confidence holds through the next hard stretch because the rep has data on themselves — data that says they've done hard things before, and did them anyway.

"Real confidence isn't built through praise. It's built through experience. Each challenge becomes evidence that you can handle the next one."

10. Progress is supposed to feel slow

The closing frame. Progress is supposed to feel slow. Growth is supposed to feel uncomfortable. Success is supposed to require patience. When today feels difficult, that isn't a signal the rep is on the wrong path. It may just mean the rep is exactly where they're supposed to be — in the middle of the boring, invisible middle where compounding does its work.

"The people who achieve extraordinary results aren't the ones who move the fastest. They're the ones who stay committed long enough to see their hard work compound into something remarkable."

11. Action items for the team

1. Reframe the daily flatness. If today feels like nothing changed, that's the normal texture of building something — not a signal to quit or panic.
2. Build a mechanism to visualise cumulative progress — a journal, a scoreboard, a monthly log. Daily perception is unreliable; the record isn't.
3. When time feels slow inside a hard stretch, remember: time will accelerate in retrospect. The stretch is not forever, even when it feels like it is.

4. Judge yourself on consistency of action, not on emotional readings of how a day felt. Behaviour is the measurement. Emotion is noise.
5. On the next lost deal that hurts, treat it as data for the next call — not as evidence you're on the wrong path. The lesson lives in the recovery.
6. Pick one thing outside work this year that will genuinely stretch you. Not for career reasons — for the muscle. Chosen discomfort keeps you sharp.
7. At the end of every month, list three things you've done that you couldn't have done six months ago. That list is proof-based confidence in action.

THE RULE OF THUMB Progress is supposed to feel slow. Growth is supposed to feel uncomfortable. Difficulty is not a signal you're on the wrong path — it's the texture of the right one. Stay consistent, judge by behaviour not emotion, and trust that the invisible daily gains will become visible at the six-month mark. Extraordinary results belong to the reps who stay committed long enough for compounding to show up.